

Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026

Assignment: Case Study 1 - Atari

Student: Richie R. (rr257)

Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%

Potential Grade: 604.00/604.00 (100.00%)

Received Grade: 0.00/604.00 (0.00%)

Started: 2/8/2026 12:55:12 PM

Updated: 2/8/2026 3:09:39 PM

Grading Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/case-study-1-atari/grading/rr257>

View Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/case-study-1-atari/view/rr257>

Instructions

1. Step 1:

From this spreadsheet, pick a game you plan to analyze (selection must be unique) and put your UCID to the left of it:

[Game Selection Spreadsheet](#)

If a selection turns red, it has already been chosen. Do not edit others' content/selection and be mindful if multiple people are working on the sheet simultaneously.

2. Step 2:

Use one of these sites to playtest and analyze your game:

- [Free 80s Arcade](#)
- [AARP Atari Games](#)
- [Keystone Kapers](#)
- [Triplets and Us](#)

If none of these work, use an alternative close to the original game.

3. Step 3:

Analyze and research your chosen game. Collect resources and include them in your responses for related sections.

4. Step 4:

Save the worksheet, export as a PDF, and upload it to the mentioned branch on GitHub. Create a pull request, merge it to main, and upload the PDF to Canvas.

Section #1: (150 pts.) Game Overview

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (50 pts.) - Game Details - Note the Game's title, developer, publisher, platform, genre, and release date

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The game, Galaxian was published by Namco and released in October 1979, and it was essentially a Fixed shooter. The developers consist of Kazunori Sawano and Shigeichi Ishimura, with programming by Kōichi Tashiro.

Website: <https://namco.fandom.com/wiki/Galaxian>



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⇒ Task #2 (50 pts.) - History and Industry - Note the historical context of the game's release and its place in the industry

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The game was actually first in production compared to Taito's space invaders, the lead game designer and planner planned out the concept 6 months before Space Invaders came out. With Galaxian coming out in 1979, and as for the historical context of the game's release, it took some inspiration of space invaders as well as taking inspiration of Star Wars which was really popular at the time. Overall, it was extremely popular and one of the first arcade games to feature true RGB graphics.

Website: <https://namco.fandom.com/wiki/Galaxian>



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⇒ Task #3 (50 pts.) - Compare the game to similar games of the time

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

Galaxian was actually similar to a game that dropped 6 months before it did, the game was called Space Invaders. In terms of genre it was pretty similar since it was a fixed-shooter. Though the additions of RGB colors truly separated and had Galaxian lead the pack initially!

Website: <https://namco.fandom.com/wiki/Galaxian>



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Section #2: (2 pts.) Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

⇒ Task #1 (1 pt.) - Core gameplay mechanics and how they shape the player's experience

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The core gameplay loop is basically you control a spaceship and you move the ship left and right and shoot at the aliens at the top of the screen. You have to survive and destroy all the aliens and sometimes the bosses will appear and you have to defeat them. Overall, like most arcade games the goal is to get the highest amount of points and so there is some incentive to take risks to try to get the most points. This keeps the game challenging but unique in the sense that it allows the player to think about what they want to do as well as keep things in mind.

Website: <https://namco.fandom.com/wiki/Galaxian>



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⇒ Task #2 (1 pt.) - Level design and how it affects gameplay

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The overall level design is pretty simple, there are waves of aliens that appear everytime you defeat an initial batch, the background is black to emphasize space and you have the aliens that appear with bosses here and there. The actual design of the level doesn't really impact gameplay since the user gets the ability to move left and right to begin with and so it really doesn't do much beyond that.



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Section #3: (150 pts.) Graphic And Audio Design

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (75 pts.) - Game's visual appearance, artistic choices, and how they contribute to the experience

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The game's visual appearance has RGB colors which was one of the first for having it at the time. If we take this into context the game's visual appearance compared to others at the time is amazing and clean, each spaceship looks different and allows the player to quickly learn what each one does and memorize what occurs. They

contribute to the experience greatly as it allows players to quickly learn but also makes it aesthetically pleasing for everyone to see.



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⇒ Task #2 (75 pts.) - Sound design, including music and sound effects, and their impact on the game

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

The games sound design in my opinion is one of the most fun and endearing things about these games. The sound of the shooting and the sound of getting shot are so memorable that whenever I hear them I think about this game! In terms of impact in my opinion they keep me coming back so I can try to not hear my ship blow up.



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Section #4: (150 pts.) Narrative And Storytelling

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (75 pts.) - Narrative structure, main plot points, and setting

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

There really isn't a direct narrative for the player to know, the game kinda just throws you in and has you shoot alien space ships, I guess a plot point could be trying to survive and wiping out the aliens? In terms of setting we are in space and as such explains why we are controlling a spaceship and fighting against aliens.



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⇒ Task #2 (75 pts.) - Character development and how it integrates with gameplay

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

Once again, there really isn't character development in this game, we simply control a spaceship and shoot at the enemies. If we want to argue there is character development, I guess we can argue on how the player learns to prevent the death of

the spaceship.



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Section #5: (150 pts.) Impact And Reception

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (75 pts.) - Critical and player reception, including reviews and feedback

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

People absolutely loved this game when it came out because most of the general's opinion was that this was a space invaders on red bull, essentially a much better and faster and more intriguing version of that other game. This game was extremely popular when it came out and it speaks volumes to how much of an audience it captured and how the sequel overshadowed it.



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⇒ Task #2 (75 pts.) - Game's impact on the gaming industry and its cultural significance

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

Lot's of games came out to try to replicate the success as well as attributing the color RBG from here and implementing to their own games. Overall, Galaxian was an extremely sucessful game and it's sequel is iconic even to this day and age with clones and replicas being made on the app store on modern devices.



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Section #6: (2 pts.) Reflection

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (1 pt.) - Was the game "fun"? What made it fun or not?

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

I chose this type of game because I was familiar with the sequel, as such I found the game really fun! I personally enjoy the gameplay loop of shooting and dodging

game really fun! I personally enjoy the gameplay loop of shooting and dodging.



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⇒ Task #2 (1 pt.) - Reflection on the learning experience and ease of research

Progress: 100%

Your Response:

Overall, going around and doing research on the prequel of the game I love was honestly pretty fun and it really highlights the changes that were to make Galaga so much better. In terms of research it was pretty straightforward and easy.



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